QSOURCE SELECTION SENSITIVE

GSA Task Order Proposal Request (TOPR) for
Certified Defense All-Source Analysis Professional Certification Program (CDASA)
Questions/Feedback and USG Responses

#	TOPR/PWS Section	Question/Feedback	USG Response
1	TOPR §13.1.1.1.7.3; PWS §7.3; QASP Performance Requirements Summary Matrix.	The TOPR requires a plan to achieve 50% staffing within 30 days and 100% within 60 days. The QASP states that Key Personnel nominations are due no later than 10 days after award. Please confirm these staffing and security-nomination milestones that will apply to contract performance and evaluation. And please confirm if these are business or calendar days. This affects recruitment commitments, transition planning, and evaluation compliance.	No solicitation amendment necessary. The TOPR staffing plan is calendar days. The QASP may be interpreted as 10 Business days.
2	PWS §7.1; Attachment D, "Core Labor (O&M)" worksheet.	Please confirm whether the labor categories, FTE quantities, and hours shown in Attachment D are mandatory Government-estimated quantities that offerors must accept without revision, or whether offerors may propose a different labor mix consistent with their technical approach. The PWS 7.1 calls the labor mix an estimate and Attachment D references the locked workbook where offerors are to enter rates but not manipulate any other cells. If a different mix is permitted, please explain how offerors should reflect it in the locked pricing workbook. Clarification is needed to ensure accurate pricing.	No, offerors cannot propose alternatives to the labor categories, FTE quantities, or hours in Attachment D; these are mandatory Government-estimated quantities that must be accepted without revision for consistent evaluation. The PWS 7.1 reference to the labor mix as an "estimate" is for planning only. The Excel Pricing Sheet is unlocked for company name (prime or subcontractor) and rate-entry cells only, do not manipulate other cells.
3	Attachment D, "Core	Please confirm the labor hours and FTE quantities. Attachment D	Please see solicitation amendment. PWS Labor Category table (sec 7.1) updated. 1 Program

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	Labor (O&M)" worksheet column G	estimation of hours does not align with the quantity in the FTE column (1 FTE listed per row). Clarity is needed to ensure accurate pricing.	Manager added, 1 Program Analyst removed in line with attachment D
4	Attachment D, "Core Labor (O&M)" worksheet	Please clarify if the government intends to utilize all LCATs in the Direct Labor section of the Core Labor tab of Attachment D in the Option Years.	No solicitation amendment is necessary. At this time, the government intends to use the LCATs in the direct labor section that are prepopulated with FTE Hours.
5	TOPR §1.5 and §14; PWS §4.1.5, 5, 6.4, and 7.2; Attachment D, "Core Labor (O&M)" worksheet."	Please clarify whether the "Optional Labor by Category" quantities in Attachment D represent evaluated surge quantities that must be included in the total evaluated price, or merely ceiling quantities that will be ordered only if surge support is activated.	No solicitation amendment is necessary. The Optional Labor Categories represent ceiling quantities that may or may not be ordered.
6	Instructions to Offerors, Period of Performance; Attachment D.	The six-month extension is identified as Option Period V in the solicitation and Pricing Summary, but referred to as "OP VI" in portions of the Core Labor worksheet. Please confirm that all "OP VI" references are intended to mean Option Period V. Clarification requested to ensure accurate pricing.	Please see Revised Excel Pricing Sheet.
7	TOPR §13.1.1.1.7.1; PWS §8.	Do offerors need to identify and commit specific individuals for the Program Manager, Psychometrician, and Senior Strategist positions at proposal submission, or may offerors demonstrate qualifications through representative candidates, position descriptions, and recruitment commitments? If named individuals are required, please confirm whether contingent hires are acceptable and if resumes are required. If resumes are required,	Per 13.1.1.1.7.3. of the TOPR, only plans are required at time of submission.

		please confirm if they count towards the maximum page count.	
8	PWS §8, Program Manager.	PWS §8 first states that the Program Manager must have eight years of experience managing large IT programs, SAFe certification, TS/SCI clearance with CI polygraph, and serve as SAFe Product Owner. The following "Minimum Qualifications" require five years of program/project management experience, while the preferred qualifications identify additional education and credential expectations. Please identify the controlling minimum requirements and clarify whether the eight-year IT-program requirement, SAFe certification, CI polygraph, and Product Owner role are mandatory to ensure appropriate staffing for the key position.	Please see PWS amendment for Senior Strategist and Program Manager minimum qualifications, and Program Manager preferred qualifications
9	PWS §§3.1 and 8; QASP §3.2; Attachment D.	Please identify which priced labor categories are expected to perform the Product Owner, Scrum Master/Team Coach, Agile Team, and System Architect/Engineer roles. Please also confirm whether these roles must be continuously staffed during base performance or are required only when directed or when surge support is activated to ensure accurate understanding and staffing.	Please see PWS amendment for Senior Strategist minimum qualifications (Product Owner). Other SAFe roles will be on an as need basis and are not expected during base performance.
10	PWS §§19/H.1–H.9.	PWS §§19/H.1–H.9 contain extensive requirements for AI/ML model development, source code, training data, model weights, hardware optimization, DevSecOps, APIs, and Government ownership. These activities do not appear in Tasks 1–5 or Attachment D's base	Sections H1-H9 contain elements that may be necessary if the program structure evolves and unique software development is required under tasks 4.1.2. (ex: CDASA dashboard) and 4.1.5. (ex: implement progress tracking and reporting, and verification mechanisms). At this time the government cannot predict how the program development will evolve.

		labor mix. Please confirm whether §§19/H.1–H.9 apply to this certification-program support requirement. If they apply, please identify the specific anticipated AI/software products, quantities, environments, CDRLs, labor categories, and pricing assumptions.	
11	PWS §§H.2.6, H.3.1, and H.3.5; Attachment C.	PWS §§H.2.6 and H.3.5 reference CDRL A009, which Attachment C identifies as the Trip Report, while §H.3.1 references CDRLs A001–A004 for delivery of source code, models, and related technical materials even though those CDRLs concern contract and program-management reports. Please correct or clarify the applicable CDRLs for any AI, software, source-code, or technical-data deliverables.	Please see PWS Amendment to H.2.6 & H.3.1
12	Instructions to Offerors, Price Proposal; TOPR §15.1 and Volume 0 instructions.	The Instructions to Offerors place the conflict-of-interest statement in the Price Proposal, while TOPR §15.1 and the proposal-volume table place it in Volume 0. Please confirm that the OCI statement or disclosure should be submitted only in Volume 0. This matters because price information is prohibited from appearing outside the price volume, and duplicating the OCI statement unnecessarily could create volume-compliance confusion.	Per the ITO, conflict of interest statement is placed in Volume 0.
13	Attachment D	Can you please explain the calculation for No. of Hours Per FTE (BP)? Our calculations show that 8 months of work based on 1912 hours for a year, we are getting 1274.5 hours for 1 FTE, not 1541 hours as listed in the workbook. This affects the pricing submission.	Please see Revised Pricing Sheet. Psychometrician hours are correct on the pricing sheet as additional hours (more than half time) may be required during the base year.

14	Instruction to Offerors; TOPR §§6.2	The Instruction to Offerors states minimum font size/style 12-point Times New Roman and TOPR §§6.2 states 12-point font either Times New Roman, Arial, or Courier New. Please confirm if Arial and Courier New fonts are permitted or if Times New Roman should be used. This could impact the amount of information to be included in the 20-page limit.	Please see revised ITO and TOPR Amendment 01
15	Attachment D (Excel Pricing Spreadsheet)	Please confirm whether the workbook's "Option Period VI" column is a mislabeling of the 6-month extension period (i.e., it should read "Option Period V") and whether Offerors are expected to enter pricing in Column R (currently unlocked), given TOPR Section 14.6 states the Government will independently calculate the extension period's evaluated price from Option Period 4 rates.	Please see revised Excel Pricing Sheet
16	PWS Sec. 7.1, 8, 3.1, 4.1.1.1	The Base Labor Categories table (PWS Sec. 7.1) and Surge Labor Mix table (Sec. 7.2) identify a specific set of LCATs and FTE counts for this effort. These tables do not align with the LCATs/columns in Attachment D pricing worksheet. For example, Program Manager is designated Key Personnel yet does not appear in either the Base or Surge labor tables in Sec. 7.1/7.2. Please confirm which document governs for proposal pricing purposes and reconcile the LCATs identified in PWS Sections 7.1/7.2 with those	Please see PWS Amendment

		presented in the Attachment D pricing worksheet.	
17	PWS Sec. 7.1, 8	Industrial Psychologist is designated Key Personnel (PWS Sec. 8) with defined minimum/preferred qualifications but is shown at 0 FTE in the Base Labor Categories table (Sec. 7.1) and does not appear in the Surge Labor Mix table (Sec. 7.2), and is not included in Subfactor 2.2's Key Personnel Qualifications criterion "Program Manager, Psychometrician, and Senior Strategist". Please clarify if this is a Key Personnel.	Please see PWS Sec 8 Amendment (removed from Key Personnel section).
18	PWS Sec. 7.1	The Instructional System Designer (1 Senior FTE, Base) has no minimum/preferred qualifications standard in PWS Sec. 8 and no explicit task description in PWS Sections 4 or 5. Please identify the specific tasks this LCAT is expected to perform.	Please see PWS Sec 8 Amendment (added to Key Personnel section). At a minimum, ISD would take part in tasks 4.1.4. & 4.1.5.
19	PWS Sec. 7.1, 7.2, 16	PWS Section 16 describes an ongoing Knowledge Management Strategy (capture, sharing, transfer, and metrics), yet the Knowledge Manager LCAT shows 0 FTE in the Base Labor Categories table and appears only under Surge (activated solely upon written surge request). Please confirm which base-funded LCAT is expected to execute the Section 16 requirements absent a base-funded Knowledge Manager.	A dedicated Knowledge Manager is not expected to be required during the base year. As the program evolves, a dedicated Knowledge Manager may be required.
20	PWS Sec. 3.1, 7.1, 7.2	PWS Section 3.1 directs the Contractor to "establish and support" SAFe roles including Product Owners and Scrum Masters/Team Coaches. No LCAT in either the Base (Sec. 7.1) or Surge (Sec. 7.2) labor tables is identified for the Scrum	See PWS Amendment. Senior Strategist (amended from Program Manager) will be expected to serve as SAFe Product Owner. Other roles may or may not be filled as needed.

		Master/Team Coach function. Please identify which LCAT is expected to fulfill this role.	
21	PWS Sec. 7.2, 3.1	Please describe the anticipated duties/tasks for the Systems Architect II LCAT (Surge, Sec. 7.2), and clarify its relationship, if any, to the Government-furnished "Solution and Enterprise Architect" SAFe role described in Sec. 3.1.	Should the program expand rapidly under task 4.1.5. to include software development or implementation (see question 10 for reference), a System Architect may be required.
22	PWS Sec. 8 - Program Manager	PWS Section 8 states the Program Manager "must have at least eight (8) years of experience managing large IT programs," then separately lists "Minimum Qualifications: Five (5) years of experience in program management, project management, or a related field." Please clarify which standard constitutes the actual minimum qualification for evaluation purposes and confirm whether "large IT programs" experience is a mandatory minimum given this effort.	See question # 8
23	PWS Sec. 8 - Program Manager	PWS Section 8 states that "All Personnel must have an adjudicated Top-Secret Clearance with SCI eligibility," while the CI Polygraph requirement appears only in the Program Manager qualification narrative. Please confirm that the CI Polygraph is required solely for the Program Manager position and not for other Key Personnel or non-key LCATs. If confirmed, please also clarify whether the Program Manager's CI Polygraph must be current and adjudicated at the time of proposal submission, or whether it may be processed/completed after contract award for a PM with an active TS/SCI.	Please see PWS Amendment. Removed from Program Manager description, added to section 8. All personnel must have a CI polygraph.
24	PWS Sec. 7.3 / Instructions	PWS Section 7.3 states staffing nominations of 50% at 30 business	Please see amendment to PWS, sec 7.3. Subfactor 2.2 timelines are correct and should be

	to Offerors Subfactor 2.2	days, 75% at 60 business days, and 100% at 90 business days, while the Subfactor 2.2 evaluation criterion references staffing milestones of 50% within 30 days and 100% within 60 days. Please reconcile these two timelines and clarify whether "staffing nomination" (submission to DIA security for adjudication) is equivalent to "staffed" (personnel actually cleared and performing) for purposes of measuring compliance.	considered the operative timelines. For compliance purposes, qualified personnel should be in the nomination process with DIA security.
25	PWS Sec. 19	PWS Section 19 imposes extensive data-rights, delivery, and documentation requirements specific to AI/ML models, training pipelines, and software. Similar software/AI-development language also appears in Section 6.1 ("model retraining" as an Operations and Maintenance activity) and Section 17.1 ("Code Quality & Defect Rate," "System Availability & Uptime — 99.9%"). None of the tasks described in PWS Sections 4 or 5 involve AI/ML development, model training, or software delivery. Please confirm the applicability or clarify whether they were included in error.	See question #10
26	TOPR Sec. 4.2 / Instructions to Offerors - Page Limitations	Please confirm that the 20-page limit identified for Volume I applies collectively to both Section 1 (Security Verification) and Section 2 (Technical Proposal) combined, rather than 20 pages allotted separately to each section.	Per TOPR 6.3 and Instructions to Offerors (Page Limitations table), the 20-page limit applies collectively to Volume I (Section 1 Security + Section 2 Technical). Cover letter, TOC, glossary excluded (TOPR 6.1).
27	TOPR Sec. 6.2 / Instructions to Offerors - Formatting	The Instructions to Offerors specify 9-point Arial for tables and 8-point Arial for graphics, while TOPR Section 6.2 specifies a 10-point font for figures in tables, headers/footers, and graphic	Please see revised ITO and TOPR Amendment 01.

		captions. Please confirm which standard governs.	
28	TOPR Sec. 1.5 - CLIN Structure	Please clarify whether CLIN 5 (Contract Data Deliverables) requires separately proposed labor pricing, given that CDRL preparation appears to be performed by labor already priced under CLIN 1 (Base Labor) and CLIN 2 (Surge Labor).	CLIN 5 does not require separate pricing, please provide pricing IAW the Excel Pricing Sheet.
29	PWS Sec. 12 - Place of Performance	PWS Section 12 states that priority for Government-furnished seating will be given to Key Personnel and personnel in other mission-critical roles "as determined by the Government," with the Contractor responsible for workspace for all remaining personnel, but does not identify which positions or locations this applies to. For each LCAT identified in PWS please identify: (a) the specific anticipated place of performance (DIA HQ/JBAB, Reston, or Pentagon) for that position, and (b) whether that position is expected to receive a Government-furnished seat, so that Offerors can accurately plan Contractor-furnished workspace for positions not accommodated in Government space.	Primary work is anticipated be at DIA HQ/JBAB for each of the projected funded LCATs in the base year.
30	Instructions to Offerors / TOPR Sec. 14.2, 17	The Instructions to Offerors refers to the pricing spreadsheet as "Attachment 1" ("A completed Excel spreadsheet (provided as Attachment 1)"), while the GSA TOPR refers to the same document as "Attachment D" (Sec. 14.2 and the Sec. 17 attachment list: "D. Excel Pricing Sheet"). Please confirm these refer to the same document and clarify the correct attachment designation for the pricing workbook.	Please see revised ITO.

31	PWS Sec. 19/21	The PWS section numbering skips directly from Section 19 to Section 21, with no Section 20 present. Please clarify whether Section 20 was omitted in error.	Please see PWS amendment. Corrected numbering.
32	PWS Sec. 6 / TOPR Sec. 1.5	PWS Section 6 (Contract Line-Item Number Structure) defines four CLIN categories — 6.1 Operations & Maintenance, 6.2 Travel, 6.3 Other Direct Costs, 6.4 Surge — while TOPR Section 1.5 defines a different five-CLIN structure (CLIN 1 Base Labor, CLIN 2 Surge Labor, CLIN 3 ODC Travel, CLIN 4 ODC Software, CLIN 5 Contract Data Deliverables) with different PWS section cross-references and no CDRL CLIN counterpart in Section 6. Please confirm which CLIN structure and numbering governs for pricing purposes in Attachment D.	Please see PWS & TOPR Amendments. Updated CLIN Structure in both documents.
33	Due Date/Time	Given the volume and substance of the clarification questions submitted above, Offerors will need meaningful time to incorporate the Government's responses into a compliant technical and price proposal. Will the Government extend the proposal due date by 10 business days from the date the Government issues its consolidated responses to these questions, to allow adequate time for a fully responsive submission?	Please see TOPR Amendment 01.

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